

Anwar AI ProjectFlow

AI Project Management System - Candidate Assignment

The challenge

Design a simple operating system for AI projects so management can instantly understand where every project stands, who owns the next action, what is blocking delivery, and when the project is expected to go live.

IDEA > DISCOVERY > DESIGN > DEVELOPMENT > TESTING > DEPLOYMENT > COMPLETION

The objective is not to build another generic task-management system.

Build a lightweight project-governance system specifically for AI and software initiatives across Anwar Group.

What we want to learn about you

Product thinking	Execution design	Management visibility	Technical judgment
Can you simplify a complex workflow?	Can you make progress measurable?	Can you surface risks and decisions?	Can you design a practical first version?

1. The Business Problem

Anwar Group is building an internal AI team responsible for AI-enabled systems, automations, analytics tools, and business applications across different departments. As the number of projects grows, management needs one reliable way to track progress from initial idea to final deployment.

The system should make it easy to answer:

- Where is the project now?
- Who is responsible for moving it forward?
- What is the next meaningful deliverable?
- When is it expected to be completed?
- Is the project on track, at risk, delayed, or blocked?
- What exactly is causing the delay?

2. Your Assignment

Design a simple product called Anwar AI ProjectFlow. The system should manage an AI or software project from idea to completion and make progress measurable rather than relying on verbal updates such as "development is almost finished."

North-star question

Can management open the system and understand within a few seconds: where every AI project is, what is late, why it is late, who needs to act, and when it will be delivered?

3. Recommended Project Stages

- 1. Idea / Request** Business problem or opportunity is submitted.
- 2. Discovery** Current process, users, data needs, pain points, and expected outcome are understood.
- 3. Requirements & Design** Requirements, workflow, UI/UX, technical approach, and deliverables are defined.
- 4. Approval** Business owner approves the proposed scope and solution.
- 5. Development** The approved solution is built.
- 6. Internal Testing** The project team validates functionality and resolves major issues.
- 7. Business Testing / UAT** The department tests the solution and provides feedback.
- 8. Deployment** The approved version is released to users.
- 9. Stabilization** Initial production issues and feedback are resolved.
- 10. Completed** The project is formally handed over and closed.

4. Every Project Must Show

Project basics	People	Execution	Health
Project name	Project owner	Current stage	On Track / At Risk
Business unit	Assigned AI analyst	Next milestone	Delayed / Blocked
Department	Assigned developer	Next action	Current blockers
Business problem	Business owner	Due date	Expected delivery
Expected outcome	Contributors	Overall progress	Latest update

Recommended health statuses

ON TRACK	AT RISK	DELAYED	BLOCKED
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5. Stage Gates - Progress Must Be Evidence-Based

A project should not move to the next stage simply because someone changes its status. Each stage should have clear exit criteria or deliverables.

Discovery complete	• Business problem documented • Current process understood • Users identified • Expected outcome defined
Design complete	• Requirements completed • Workflow approved • UI/UX or solution design completed • Technical approach defined
Development complete	• Required functionality developed • Internal testing completed • Major known bugs resolved
UAT complete	• Business testing completed • Feedback recorded • Critical issues resolved • Business approval received

6. Project Workspace

Each project should have one central workspace containing the information needed to execute and govern the project.

Overview

Project objective | Current stage | Project health | Expected delivery | Overall progress

People

Project owner | AI analyst | Developer | Business owner | Other contributors

Tasks

Action | Owner | Deadline | Status | Related milestone

Blockers

Blocker | Responsible person | Date identified | Impact | Required action | Resolution status

Files & Deliverables

Requirements | Designs | Development links | Test results | UAT feedback | Approvals | Final documentation

Example milestone plan

Milestone	Owner	Due date	Status
Discovery	AI Analyst	10 Sep	Completed
Requirements	AI Analyst	14 Sep	Completed
UI/UX	Designer	17 Sep	In progress
Development	Developer	30 Sep	Not started
UAT	Business Owner	5 Oct	Not started

7. Management Dashboard

The management view should prioritize exceptions and decisions, not simply display charts. It should show:

- Total active AI projects
- Projects by stage
- Projects on track / at risk / delayed / blocked
- Projects expected this month
- Upcoming and overdue milestones
- AI analyst workload
- Developer workload
- Major blockers and decisions requiring management attention

Management test

The dashboard should answer: Which projects require my attention today - and why?

8. Delay and Change Management

When a milestone is overdue, the system should capture the reason instead of simply showing it in red.

- Requirements not finalized
- Waiting for business feedback
- Data unavailable
- Development issue
- Integration dependency
- Resource unavailable
- Scope change
- Testing issue
- Approval pending
- Other

The system should also record scope changes, who requested them, why they were requested, and the impact on delivery. Management should be able to distinguish execution delay from delay caused by added scope.

9. Roles

AI Analyst	Create project information; manage discovery and requirements; track progress; coordinate business users and developers; record blockers.
Developer	View assigned projects; update development work; record blockers; submit completed deliverables.
Business Owner	Review requirements; provide feedback; approve design; perform UAT; approve the completed solution.
AI Team Lead / Project Manager	View all projects; assign resources; set priorities; monitor deadlines; escalate blockers; review project health.
Management	View portfolio status, delays, delivery dates, outcomes, important blockers, and decisions requiring attention.

10. Important Design Principles

One Project Owner: One person is accountable for delivery.

One Current Stage: Everyone agrees where the project currently stands.

One Next Milestone: The next meaningful deliverable is clear.

One Next Action: Someone is responsible for moving the project forward.

One Expected Delivery Date: Management has a clear delivery expectation.

11. What You Do Not Need to Build

- Financial accounting
- Employee attendance
- GitHub or source-code management
- Complex resource planning
- Full Jira functionality
- Full ERP integration
- Advanced autonomous AI agents

Focus on AI project execution, accountability, deadlines, and management visibility.

12. What You Need to Submit

A. Problem Understanding

- Main project-management problem
- How you would structure AI projects
- How you would measure real progress
- How you would identify delays

B. UI/UX

- AI project portfolio
- Project dashboard
- Project creation
- Project stage / timeline
- Milestones and tasks
- Blocker management
- UAT / approval
- Management dashboard

C. Technical Design

- Simple architecture
- Database structure
- User roles
- Project workflow
- Notification approach

D. Prototype

- Demonstrate the required project journey below

Prototype journey

New project created -> AI analyst assigned -> Discovery completed -> Design approved -> Development starts -> Milestone becomes delayed -> Blocker recorded -> Development completed -> UAT approved -> Project deployed -> Project closed.

13. How We Will Evaluate Your Work

- Understanding of AI project execution
- Simplicity of the system
- Ability to measure real progress
- Project-stage design
- Deadline and milestone management
- Ownership and accountability
- Management visibility
- UI/UX
- Technical thinking
- Quality of the prototype

Final note

Do not build a generic project-management tool. Design a system specifically for an organization building multiple AI and software solutions simultaneously. The successful solution should make execution visible, accountable, measurable, and predictable from idea to deployment.